



Your presentation preparation worksheet

Every good business presentation passes three tests.

- Fit: it is built specifically for the people in the room.
- Focus: it carries a clear message in a simple three-act story.
- Flair: it opens with clarity, signposts the key points, and ends with certainty, so it lands and sticks.

Use this worksheet to review the actual presentation you will deliver at the face-to-face sessions in Barcelona. It gathers the work from the online modules into one place, so you can see the whole thing and sharpen it.

How to use it

This week, complete Part A (Fit) and Part B (Focus). This is where you write it down and make it sharper.

Next week, complete Part C (Flair) as we work through Modules 3 and 4.

Part A · Fit: Understand the audience before you write anything

Start with the audience, not the slides. What they need to hear decides what you can leave out. Answer these before you shape anything else.

1. Your audience

Think about the people you'll present to; if you don't know them well, do a little research and ask people who know them. Then answer, giving most attention to what they need to hear and what they do not.

Who are they, and what do they care about? What are their challenges? Priorities?

What do they need to hear from you? What do they know about your subject? What don't they know? How do they feel and think about what you are proposing?



What do they not need to hear, that you can safely cut from the presentation?

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2. Your statement of intent – Know, understand, do...

Two lines at most. Begin with the words “After my presentation, what do I want this audience to know, understand, do”

Version 1

Know:	
Understand:	
Do:	

Fit check

- ☐ I can name who is in the room, what matters to them and what they need from me.
- ☐ I know why my subject is relevant and or important to them.
- ☐ I have decided what to leave out.



Part B · Focus: get your story straight

One message. Three points. One decision. If you cannot say it in a sentence, it is not ready yet.

3. Your one-sentence message

In a single sentence, what is the argument you are making? If you cannot fill this with something clear and convincing, you do not have a story yet.

E.G. If we want to achieve our sales goals for next year there are three things that we need to do now. A, B and C.

Version 2, sharper, simpler, more direct

Version 3, sharper, simpler, more direct

4. Your three-act story

Set the argument out in three acts. Each act needs a headline that moves the argument forward.

Act 1, WHY. The characters, the context and the challenge. Why this matters, and why now.

E.G. This is where we have been, this is where we are now, this is where we want to get to and why it matters (to us/you)

Act 2, HOW. What we've done, or what we are going to do, with just enough detail. Meaning before detail.

E.G. We did A, B & C to get us to where we are now...



Act 3, WHAT. The result, and the first step you are asking for. End on a positive, useful note.

E.G. This is where we stand today and what we are going to do tomorrow. This is what we need from you and what we need you to do.

Story summary

Pull the key points of each act into this grid. Keep each cell short.

Act 1 · WHY	Act 2 · HOW	Act 3 · WHAT
- Look back to where we have been. - Come to the present day. - Identify the challenge or opportunity we face. - Remind the room why it matters. - How it links to their priorities.	- Take them on the journey from where we are now. - To where we want to be. - Step by step. - At the right level of detail for them.	- What we have achieved so far. - Introduce the goal they can measure. - Outline the plan and the next steps. - Ask for the help you need from them.

5. Soundbites and killer statistics

The one short phrase, statistic or fact that is so important that people will remember it long after they have forgotten the rest of the presentation. It usually comes out of the story once you know what you want to say. If it is the only thing they remember, it has to be good.

E.G: 98% of wrong medication incidents are caused by human error.

Focus check

- ☐ I understand the argument that I am making and can describe it in a single sentence.
- ☐ The three-act story outline is clear.
- ☐ The story delivers on the promise of my one sentence.



Part C · Flair: make it land and stick

You have the story. Now open well, guide the audience through it, and end with certainty. Complete this part next week, alongside Modules 3 and 4.

6. Your prologue, the golden first minute

Before Act 1, a short opening – ‘the golden minute’ that earns their attention. It does three things: states the big idea, shows why it matters now, and sets out what to expect and what you need from them.

Question Prompt	Your notes
What is the big idea? What is this really about?	<i>E.G. Insurance claim fraud cost us £15m last year. If we could reduce that by 50% over three years it would add £22.5m to our bottom line.</i>
Why now? Timely, because we must start now, or timeless, because it always matters.	<i>E.G. And in a tough economic period that matters more than ever...</i>
What will the audience see and hear in this presentation?	<i>E.G. Today we will show you how investing in a piece of software that can detect lying over the phone will help us reduce fraudulent claims to help us meet that goal.</i>
What do you need from them? Attention, a decision, support?	We are asking for a £2.5m investment that will pay back in the first year and has delivered X in the trial period.

Now write your prologue

7. Add impact to the three acts

For each act, write a headline the audience could repeat, the one message to signpost, and a simple visual idea. Slides illustrate, they do not explain. One idea per slide.

Act	Headline	Message to signpost	Visual or slide idea
1 WHY	<i>E.G. Our GTM process isn't fit for fast growth.</i>		
2 HOW	<i>E.G. We will upgrade three things: A, B & C</i>		
3 WHAT	<i>E.G. Which will deliver these results....</i>		



Act	Headline	Message to signpost	Visual or slide idea

Signpost the key messages

Audiences remember the beginning and the end, and signposting helps guide them to the key points in the middle of a complex presentation. Signposting can also help identify key messages for specific groups of people in the audience. Write two or three signpost lines you will use, for example “Here is the most important thing we found...”. “This matters most to the sales directors in the audience...” or “So what does this mean for Puig?”

8. Your epilogue, end with certainty

Do not taper off. Close with clarity and confidence, and return to where you began.

Prompt	Your notes
What is the one takeaway you want to reinforce?	
What should the audience do, think or feel next?	
How will you connect the ending back to your opening?	
Is there a line or image that closes it with impact?	

Now write your epilogue



Flair check

- ☐ My first minute states the big idea, says why now, and sets expectations.
- ☐ Each act has a headline a listener could repeat at lunch.
- ☐ Each slide holds one idea. The slides support me; they are not my notes.
- ☐ My ending returns to my opening and states the next step.

9. Your slides

Do your slides pass the '3-second' test?

Does every slide make a single point – one idea per slide, one idea at a time?

Do the headlines of each slide make the meaning clear?

Are you using animation to help you add emphasis and impact?

Before Barcelona · the final check

Read your draft once more and ask:

- ☐ Will the audience understand why this matters to them, in the first minute?
- ☐ Can you summarise your argument in one sentence?
- ☐ Are there three clear points, and no more?
- ☐ Have you removed unnecessary detail?
- ☐ Is the conclusion and the next step clear?

Use this worksheet to help you sharpen your message, your story, and your slides for your face-to-face training in Barcelona. It is the draft we will rehearse and sharpen together.